TOP 5

INDIA'S MOST IMPROVED GENERAL UNIVERSITIES (GOVERNMENT)

RANK	UNIVERSITY	CITY
1	UNIVERSITY OF LUCKNOW	LUCKNOW
2	GURU GOBIND SINGH INDRAPRASTHA UNIVERSITY	NEW DELHI
3	UNIVERSITY OF DELHI	NEW DELHI
4	BHARATHIAR UNIVERSITY	COIMBATORE
5	ACHARYA NAGARJUNA UNIVERSITY	GUNTUR

The Most Improved Universities are ranked based on their percentage growth in ranking over the past five years (2022-2026) in the India Today-MDRA Best Universities Ranking

TOP 5

GOVERNMENT UNIVERSITIES OFFERING HIGHEST NUMBER OF PG COURSES

RANK	UNIVERSITY	NO. OF PG COURSES
1	ALIGARH MUSLIM UNIVERSITY, ALIGARH	148
2	OSMANIA UNIVERSITY, HYDERABAD	96
3	ANNAMALAI UNIVERSITY, ANNAMALAINAGAR	93
4	SRI VENKATESWARA UNIVERSITY, TIRUPATI	81
5	GURU NANAK DEV UNIVERSITY, AMRITSAR	79
5	UNIVERSITY OF MYSORE, MYSURU	79

TOP 5

GOVERNMENT UNIVERSITIES OFFERING HIGHEST NUMBER OF PhDs IN PAST THREE YEARS

RANK	UNIVERSITY	NO. OF PhDs
1	OSMANIA UNIVERSITY, HYDERABAD	2,728
2	JAWAHARLAL NEHRU UNIVERSITY, NEW DELHI	2,525
3	UNIVERSITY OF DELHI, NEW DELHI	2,456
4	ANNAMALAI UNIVERSITY, ANNAMALAINAGAR	2,082
5	BHARATHIAR UNIVERSITY, COIMBATORE	1,604

TOP 5

GOVERNMENT UNIVERSITIES WITH HIGHEST NUMBER OF PATENTS FILED IN PAST THREE YEARS

RANK	UNIVERSITY	NO. OF PATENTS
1	UNIVERSITY OF ALLAHABAD, PRAYAGRAJ	158
2	GURU GHASIDAS VISHWAVIDYALAYA, BILASPUR	154
3	ANNAMALAI UNIVERSITY, ANNAMALAINAGAR	153
4	OSMANIA UNIVERSITY, HYDERABAD	146
5	DEEN DAYAL UPADHYAYA GORAKHPUR UNIVERSITY, GORAKHPUR	127

socially conscious graduates," he says. Under the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, the university is reshaping its curriculum, encouraging interdisciplinary learning and investing in research, innovation and entrepreneurship.

Instead of assessing doctoral scholars only through academic publications, DU is widening the definition of research excellence. Students who develop patents, build prototypes, create technologies with social impact or establish successful startups will also receive academic recognition.

The university plans to support promising student ventures with incubation facilities, seed funding, legal and accounting support, as well as mentoring. "The mindset has to shift from job-seeking to job creation," says Singh. Entrepreneurship has already found a place in undergraduate education.

The implementation of NEP has also accelerated flexibility in learning. Under DU's major-minor academic structure, students are no longer confined to a single discipline. An English major can earn a minor in journalism, a Computer Science student can study Psychology, while someone pursuing Hindu Studies can complement it with management or Computer Science. "We are making education more porous," says Singh. "Students should be free to explore their interests instead of remaining locked into one academic silo." New value-added courses also reflect this wider definition of education. Financial literacy has emerged as one of the university's most popular offerings, attracting nearly 30,000 students.

Teaching methods are changing as